STROMEX

EXECUTIVE KNOWLEDGE SYSTEM

BOOK II

II

Market Strategy & Competitive Positioning

Who we serve · Who we compete with · Why we win

The StromeX Editorial Bible · Edition II

AUTHORITY — STRATEGIC

13 AUGUST 2026 · VERSION 2.0

BOOK II

Market Strategy & Competitive Positioning

Who we serve · Who we compete with · Why we win

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Volume II locates the company in its market. It identifies four converging structural forces — the collapsed cost of building software against the unchanged cost of finishing it, the decade-long lag in institutional digitisation, the growing enforceability of credential fraud, and the shift from projects to subscriptions — and sets out the founding market thesis with its risks stated alongside. It supplies a method for market sizing rather than a headline figure, anatomises the buyer and the four other people in the room, applies established findings in behavioural economics while naming the techniques the group refuses to use, classifies the competitive landscape into six classes each requiring a different response, sets out the seven wedges, and closes with an honest assessment of the moat in which every advantage is stated together with the condition under which it expires.

One book of ten. The corpus index and the other nine are at docs/library/.

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External data cited in this corpus is attributed at the point of use and listed in the Bibliography. Figures describing the group’s own delivered work are drawn from the sources recorded in Internal Sources.

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NAVIGATION

Contents

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APPARATUS

List of Tables

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VOLUME

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CHAPTER 1 — THE STRUCTURAL OPPORTUNITY

1.1 Four forces, converging

StromeX is not betting on a trend. It is positioned at the intersection of four independent structural forces, each of which would justify a company on its own, and whose convergence is the actual opportunity.

*Force 1 — The cost of building software collapsed, but the cost of *finishing* it did not. AI-assisted development has compressed the labour required to produce working software by a large factor. It has compressed the labour required to* specify, integrate, migrate, train, support and maintain* software by very little. The result is a widening gap: an explosion of software that mostly does not get adopted, and a scarcity premium on organisations that can actually land it. StromeX is architected to arbitrage exactly this gap — heavy AI leverage on production, deliberately human investment on landing.

Force 2 — Institutional digitisation in emerging markets is a decade behind and moving fast. Most African, South Asian and Middle Eastern institutions have already digitised communications (WhatsApp reached them before any ERP did) but have not digitised *records* — admissions, finance, credentials, HR, assets. The gap between "has a smartphone" and "has a system of record" is the single largest addressable inefficiency in these economies, and mobile penetration means the last-mile problem is already solved for us.

Force 3 — Credential fraud is becoming enforceable. Certificate and transcript forgery has always been endemic; what changed is that employers, universities and immigration authorities increasingly *check*, and increasingly check digitally. An institution whose credentials cannot be verified online is beginning to suffer real consequences for its graduates. This converts verification from a nice-to-have into a competitive necessity for the institution — which is the strongest possible position for a vendor.

Force 4 — Procurement is shifting from projects to subscriptions. Institutions that once bought a system every eight years now expect to rent capability continuously. This is unambiguously good for a company designed around recurring revenue and continuous delivery, and unambiguously bad for the incumbent consultancies whose model depends on large, infrequent, capitalised projects.

1.2 The founding market thesis

Begin in Nigerian education, for six specific reasons, none of which is sentiment:

1. **Volume.** Nigeria has tens of thousands of private secondary and primary schools and hundreds of tertiary institutions, overwhelmingly under-served by software.
2. **Willingness to pay.** Private schools charge fees and compete on prestige. Prestige is purchasable, and modern digital infrastructure is visible prestige to fee-paying parents.
3. **Proof exists.** Reference Implementation №1 (SHRS) demonstrates end-to-end delivery on a real institution.
4. **The buying committee is small.** A proprietor or principal can sign. Compare a hospital or a ministry, where the same decision takes eleven months.
5. **Referral density.** School proprietors know other school proprietors. Word of mouth in this market is unusually efficient, which matters enormously when paid acquisition is uneconomic.
6. **Everything generalises.** A school is a small institution containing every problem a large one has: identity, records, money, credentials, communications, compliance, assets, people. Solving education properly builds layers 1–7 of the Chapter 2 stack for every other sector.

The corresponding risk, stated honestly: the Nigerian private education market is price-sensitive, FX-exposed, and has a meaningful share of institutions whose ability to pay a recurring subscription is genuinely fragile. Volume VIII, Chapter 6 models churn and collection assumptions accordingly, and Chapter 10 of this volume carries the risk.

CHAPTER 2 — MARKET SIZING METHOD

2.1 Why this chapter contains a method rather than a number

This corpus does not print market-size figures it cannot source. Published TAM figures for "African EdTech" or "global digital transformation" vary by an order of magnitude between analysts, are frequently circular, and are almost never useful for deciding anything. What follows is the method by which the group produces its own sizing, so that any figure quoted internally can be traced to its inputs and challenged.

2.2 The bottom-up formula

For any market:

```
Serviceable Revenue  =  Σ (institutions in segment
                        × share reachable by our channel
                        × realistic win rate
                        × annual contract value at that segment's band)
```

Each of the four inputs must be independently sourced and dated:

INPUT	SOURCE OF TRUTH	REFRESH
Institution count	National registries, ministry data, accreditation bodies, licensing lists	Annually
Reachability	Our own channel data: partner coverage, sales capacity, marketing reach	Quarterly
Win rate	Our own pipeline history by segment — never an assumption	Quarterly
ACV	Volume III at the applicable band, times observed attach rate	Quarterly

Table 1 — The bottom-up formula

Rule: any market-size claim in a StromeX document must cite the four inputs and the date. A figure without inputs may not appear in a board pack, an investor document, or a proposal.

2.3 Segmentation model

Institutions are segmented by **decision complexity**, not by size or revenue — because decision complexity is what actually determines sales cost, cycle length and win rate.

SEGMENT	SIGNATURE	CYCLE	MOTION	WHERE VALUE COMES FROM
Self-serve	One person decides, pays by card	Minutes–days	Product-led, zero touch	Volume, expansion revenue
Owner-led	Proprietor/ principal/founder decides	2–8 weeks	Low-touch, one salesperson	The core of Phase I
Committee	3–8 stakeholders, budget cycle	3–9 months	Full sales cycle, proposal, pilot	Higher ACV, stickier

SEGMENT	SIGNATURE	CYCLE	MOTION	WHERE VALUE COMES FROM
Procurement	Formal tender, evaluation matrix	6–24 months	Bid team, compliance, references	Largest ACV, slowest
Programme	Multi-institution, donor or ministry funded	12–36 months	Consortium, partner-led	Transformational, high risk

Table 2 — Segmentation model

Phase I deliberately concentrates on self-serve and owner-led. Committee and procurement open in Phase II, and only once the reference base makes them winnable — bidding for a ministry contract without twenty referenceable schools is not ambition, it is a donation of proposal costs.

CHAPTER 3 — THE BUYER ANATOMY

3.1 The economic buyer

Who actually signs, by sector:

SECTOR	SIGNS	CARES MOST ABOUT	KILLS DEALS OVER
Private K-12	Proprietor / Director	Prestige, parent perception, fee collection	Price, and fear of disruption during term
Public K-12	Ministry / Board	Compliance, reporting, cost per student	Procurement irregularity
University	Registrar / VC / Bursar	Accreditation, integrity of records	Data migration risk
Hospital	MD / CMD / Admin	Patient throughput, regulatory compliance	Clinical risk, downtime
Government	Permanent Secretary / DG	Delivery visibility, audit defensibility	Anything resembling scandal
Bank / Fintech	COO / CTO	Regulatory posture, uptime	Security review failure
Publisher	Publisher / MD	Speed to market, unit economics	Quality of finish
SME	Owner	Getting customers, getting paid	Complexity, monthly cost
NGO	Country Director	Donor reporting, beneficiary data	Cost per beneficiary
Mosque / Church	Imam / Board / Trustee	Community trust, propriety	Anything culturally careless

Table 3 — The economic buyer

3.2 The other four people in the room

The economic buyer signs, but four other roles decide:

- —**The champion** — usually an ICT coordinator, a young registrar, or an ambitious head of department. They want the institution modernised and their own standing raised by having brought it. *We arm them with materials they can present as their own.*
- —**The blocker** — typically the person whose manual process is being automated, or an incumbent vendor's relationship holder. Their objection is real and is never actually about the feature list. *We address it by naming it: this changes your role, here is the training, here is what you get to do instead.*
- —**The technical evaluator** — asks about hosting, backups, security, integration, and exit. *We answer with documentation, not reassurance.* The published security posture and the free export guarantee close more technical evaluations than any demo.
- —**The finance gate** — the bursar. Wants predictability above all, and hates variable bills. *We win here on published, itemised, plannable pricing — this is where transparency converts directly into revenue.*

3.3 The five objections and their answers

OBJECTION	WHAT’S UNDERNEATH	OUR ANSWER
“It’s too expensive”	*I can’t predict the total*	The configurator: itemised, running total, 3-year total, before we take their name
“We’ll do it next term”	*I’m afraid of disruption mid-year*	Phased go-live; parallel running; nothing is switched off until the replacement is proven
“Our staff won’t use it”	*Correct, if you don’t train them*	Included training, in-language, on their devices, plus adoption reporting we’re accountable for
“What if you disappear?”	*We’ve been abandoned before*	Free complete export, open formats, source-available options, published status history
“Can’t we just use WhatsApp/Excel?”	*Genuinely, sometimes yes*	Then do — and here’s the free tier. We win them when they outgrow it, and they will

Table 4 — The five objections and their answers

That last answer is doctrine, not politeness. Telling a 40-student school that they do not need our ERP builds more revenue over ten years than selling it to them today.

CHAPTER 4 — BUYER PSYCHOLOGY

Synthesis of well-established findings in behavioural economics, consumer psychology and pricing research, applied to our specific market. No fabricated studies; where a principle is contested, it is flagged.

4.1 Principles we deliberately apply

Anchoring. The first number a buyer sees frames every subsequent number. We anchor with the *complete ecosystem* price and then show how little the entry configuration costs — the entry price feels like relief rather than expense. This is legitimate because the anchor is a real, purchasable configuration, not an inflated decoy.

Loss aversion, applied to their loss, not manufactured fear. People weigh losses more heavily than equivalent gains. We frame around losses the institution is *already suffering* and can verify — staff hours, uncollected fees, forged certificates in circulation — never around invented threats. The distinction between "here is what you are already losing" and "here is what might happen to you" is the line between honest framing and fear-selling, and Volume I §11.2.6 makes the latter prohibited.

Choice architecture. Excessive choice reduces conversion. Our configurator's default view offers a small number of curated configurations, with full modularity one click away. Both are real; neither is hidden.

The endowment effect, earned through the free tier. People value what they already possess. An institution that has used free StromeX tools for a year already feels ownership. This is the primary conversion mechanism of Chapter 5 of Volume I and is worth more than any discount.

Transparency as a trust shortcut. In low-trust markets, published pricing is not merely convenient — it is *evidence of character*. It signals we are not deciding what to charge based on how wealthy you look. In our founding market this is the single most disarming thing we do.

Social proof, correctly scoped. A proprietor is moved by the school down the road, not by a Fortune 500 logo. Reference customers are recruited and celebrated *locally*.

Reciprocity. Substantial free value given before any ask creates genuine obligation. This works only when the gift is real; a "gift" with strings attached inverts into resentment.

4.2 Techniques we deliberately refuse

Each of these reliably increases short-term conversion and reliably degrades trust. All are prohibited:

- Manufactured scarcity ("3 slots left this month")
- Fake countdown timers
- Decoy pricing designed purely to make the middle tier look good
- Drip pricing — a low headline that grows during checkout
- Pre-ticked add-ons
- Confirmshaming ("No thanks, I prefer wasting money")
- Cancellation obstacle courses
- Roach-motel onboarding — easy in, hard out
- Sales pressure on institutions that clearly cannot afford the commitment

4.3 The presentation of price

Derived from the founder's instruction that prices should never look shocking, and that the elite tiers should look genuinely premium:

7. **Show unit economics, not just totals.** "$0.12 per certificate" lands very differently from "$1,200 for 10,000 certificates" — and both are true, so we show both.
8. **Show cost per beneficiary.** "$1.40 per student per year" is the number a proprietor can defend to a board.
9. **Show the comparison the buyer would make anyway.** Manual cost, incumbent cost, cost of doing nothing.
10. **Never hide the total.** The running total is always on screen.
11. **Let premium look premium.** Elite pricing is presented without apology, hedging, or discount language. A discounted Elite tier is a contradiction — the price is part of the assurance.
12. **Annual framing for recurring, one-time framing for capital.** Institutions budget in these two shapes; matching their mental accounting reduces friction honestly.

CHAPTER 5 — THE COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

5.1 The six competitor classes

We do not have one competitor. We have six kinds, and they must be beaten differently.

Class 1 — Global horizontal SaaS

Examples: Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Salesforce, Zoho, HubSpot **Strength:** enormous, trusted, cheap at the entry point, already installed. **Weakness:** generic. They supply capability, not outcome. Nobody at Microsoft will migrate your student records or design your certificate. **Our posture: integrate, never fight.** We are the sector layer on top. A school on Google Workspace is a *better* prospect, not a worse one — the plumbing is already there. Explicit interoperability with these platforms is a permanent product requirement, not a roadmap item.

Class 2 — Global vertical SaaS

Examples: PowerSchool, Blackbaud, Ellucian, Instructure, Epic, Tyler Technologies **Strength:** deep domain functionality, decades of accumulated edge cases, entrenched. **Weakness:** priced for North America and Western Europe; implementation costs that exceed our entire contract value; localisation that stops at currency; and near-total absence from our founding markets. **Our posture:** avoid direct collision in their home markets during Phases I–II. Win our markets so completely that when we enter theirs in Phase III we arrive with scale, references and a structural cost advantage rather than as a challenger.

Class 3 — Regional and local vendors

Examples: local school-management systems, regional ERP shops, national portal builders **Strength:** local presence, local language, local price, existing relationships. **Weakness:** thin engineering, weak design, no security posture, no roadmap, high abandonment risk, single-product. Most cannot survive their founder leaving. **Our posture: this is the real competitive fight of Phase I.** We win on completeness, craft, reliability and published pricing. We must be careful not to win on arrogance — many of these vendors are the incumbent relationship, and the graceful path is often to acquire them, partner with them, or absorb their customers when they fail rather than to attack them.

Class 4 — Consultancies and systems integrators

Examples: Big Four advisory arms, regional SI firms, agency networks **Strength:** boardroom access, procurement fluency, credibility with ministries and donors. **Weakness:** they sell hours. Their incentive is duration, not outcome. They own no IP, so every engagement restarts from zero and the client pays for it. **Our posture: partner where they have access we lack; compete where the client has been burned.** Our decisive advantage is that we own the product, so our incentive is a fast, correct, permanent implementation. Say this plainly in competitive situations, without disparagement.

Class 5 — Freelancers and small agencies

Strength: cheap, fast, personally accountable, everywhere. *Weakness:* no continuity, no security, no support, no scale, no exit path. The single largest cause of abandoned institutional software in our market. **Our posture:** we do not compete at the bottom of this market — we *recruit* it. The best of these become StromeX Partners (Volume V, Chapter 6), which converts the most fragmented part of the competitive landscape into our distribution network.

Class 6 — AI-native newcomers

Strength: fast, cheap, technically current, no legacy. *Weakness:* almost all are a thin layer over a foundation model with no system of record, no implementation capability, no hardware, no compliance posture, and no reason for an institution to trust them with student data. **Our posture:** this is the class that could genuinely disrupt us, and it deserves respect rather than dismissal. Our defence is not our model — models commoditise. Our defence is layers 1–5 of the Volume I stack: the record, the identity, the credentials, the money, the physical estate. **A competitor can replicate our intelligence layer in a quarter. Replicating an institution's ten-year system of record takes ten years.**

5.2 The competitive rules

13. Never disparage a competitor by name to a customer. Compare on specifics, in writing, verifiably.
14. Never claim a capability we do not have. If a competitor genuinely does something better, say so and explain the trade.
15. Never win a deal by promising a delivery date we have not capacity-checked.
16. Losing to a better fit is acceptable. Losing to a worse product because we communicated badly is a defect and is reviewed like one.
17. Every loss is logged with a real reason. "Price" is almost never the real reason and is not accepted as one without evidence.

CHAPTER 6 — WHY WE WIN — THE SEVEN WEDGES

Seven advantages. None is individually decisive; the combination is very hard to assemble, which is precisely why it is the strategy.

Wedge 1 — Radical price transparency. Published, itemised, module-level pricing in a market where opacity is the norm. It disarms the finance gate, shortens the cycle, removes the negotiation tax, and signals character. Competitors can copy this — but Class 3 and 4 competitors mostly *cannot*, because their margins depend on the opacity.

Wedge 2 — Completeness. Website, portal, ERP, identity, credentials, payments, hardware, design, print, publishing and consulting from one accountable supplier. The institution stops being the integrator of last resort. No competitor class covers more than a third of this span.

Wedge 3 — The free layer. A permanently free tier substantial enough to be the market's default toolkit, and free verification forever. It builds distribution where paid acquisition does not work and converts the trust problem into a trust asset.

Wedge 4 — AI leverage with human accountability. Heavy AI leverage on production (design, drafting, code, translation, layout, data migration), deliberate human investment on judgement and landing. This produces developed-market quality at emerging-market cost — the structural margin advantage the whole plan rests on. Disclosed, never concealed (Volume I §7.2).

Wedge 5 — Craft. In a market where "good enough" is the norm, finished work is a moat. It is the reason for referral, the reason for premium pricing, and the reason an institution shows its portal to a rival proprietor.

Wedge 6 — The physical bridge. Almost no software company will also print your ID cards, install your gate, coordinate your UK book printing and design your prospectus. It is operationally messy and lower-margin — which is exactly why it is defensible. It also anchors the relationship in the institution's physical reality, where switching costs are real.

Wedge 7 — Emerging-market-native architecture. Offline-first, low-bandwidth, low-spec-device, intermittent-power, multi-currency, bidirectional-language, cash-adjacent. Retrofitting this into a product designed for fibre and mains power is close to impossible, which is why Class 1 and 2 competitors will not do it.

CHAPTER 7 — POSITIONING STATEMENTS

7.1 The group positioning

> **For institutions that need to become modern and cannot afford to get it wrong, StromeX is the digital transformation company that builds the whole ecosystem — software, design, identity, credentials, payments, publishing and physical infrastructure — at a published price, with the craft of a developed-market firm and the economics of an emerging-market one.**

7.2 The one-liner

> **StromeX builds the institution's operating system.**

7.3 By audience

AUDIENCE	STATEMENT
School proprietor	"Everything your school needs to run and to be seen as serious — website, portal, admissions, results, fees, verifiable certificates, ID cards — from one company, at a price on the website."
University registrar	"Records you can defend at accreditation, credentials the world can verify, and a migration we take responsibility for."
Ministry	"Delivery you can see, records you can audit, and a supplier whose pricing is public."
Hospital administrator	"Patient records, staff, billing and compliance in one system that works when the power doesn't."
SME owner	"Get found, get paid, get organised. Start free."
Publisher / author	"From manuscript to a book printed in the UK or US, designed to a standard your readers will notice."
Developer	"Open design system, open formats, documented APIs, free verification. Build on us."
Investor	"Recurring institutional infrastructure revenue in the fastest-growing markets on earth, with a structural cost advantage and a free layer that owns distribution."
Prospective employee	"Build things that matter for institutions that have never had them, to a standard that would pass in London, without moving there."

Table 5 — By audience

7.4 The five proof points every asset must be able to substantiate

18. Published, itemised pricing — verifiable on the website, right now.
19. Reference Implementation №1 delivered end-to-end.
20. Free tier and free credential verification, permanent, no card.
21. Complete data export, open format, no fee — contractual.

22. Public status page and published incident history.

Marketing may not claim a sixth thing until a sixth thing is true.

CHAPTER 8 — WHAT WE REFUSE TO COMPETE ON

Price as the primary axis. There is always someone cheaper. Competing on price against an operator with no engineering costs, no security posture and no intention of existing in three years is a race to a place we do not want to arrive at. We compete on transparency and completeness, and we let the cheap option be cheap.

Feature count. Feature-list warfare produces bloated products and is won by whoever has the most engineers. We compete on whether the institution's actual problem is solved.

Model benchmarks. We do not market on which foundation model we use or how it scores. Models commoditise; the record does not.

Speed of announcement. We do not pre-announce. A thing is announced when a customer can buy it. This costs us press and saves us the credibility that press would eventually consume.

Being everywhere at once. Geographic and sector breadth is the twenty-year plan, and depth is the twelve-month rule (Volume I §2.4).

Prestige logos we did not earn. No customer appears in our marketing without written permission and an accurate description of what we actually did for them.

CHAPTER 9 — THE MOAT, HONESTLY ASSESSED

A moat claim is worthless without an assessment of how it fails. Each of ours is stated with its expiry condition.

MOAT	STRENGTH	TIME TO BUILD	HOW A COMPETITOR BEATS IT
System of record	Very strong	3–10 years per customer	Only by waiting for us to fail a customer badly enough to justify migration. This is the real moat.
Switching cost from physical estate	Strong	1–3 years	Rip-and-replace of gates, cards and readers — expensive and disruptive, rarely worth it
Free-tier distribution	Strong	2–4 years	A better-funded rival giving away more. Real risk in Phase III. Defence: quality and breadth, not volume of giveaway
Craft and reputation	Moderate–strong	3–7 years	Hiring better designers than us. Entirely possible; requires them to also want our markets
Price transparency	Moderate	Immediate to copy	Trivially copyable in principle; blocked in practice by competitors whose margins require opacity. Assume erosion by Phase III
Partner network	Moderate	2–5 years	Outbidding us on partner economics. Defence: partners who are genuinely better off with us
Cost structure	Moderate	1–3 years	Any competitor adopting the same AI-leverage model. **Assume this advantage is temporary and largely gone by 2032.** It funds the durable moats; it is not itself durable
Regulatory / data residency posture	Moderate	2–4 years per market	Investment. Slow but not hard

Table 6 — The Moat, Honestly Assessed

The honest conclusion: only the system of record and the physical estate are genuinely durable. Everything else is a head start. The strategic implication is direct and governs Phase I: **get institutions onto the record as fast as possible, at whatever depth they will accept, and make leaving unattractive by being good rather than by being sticky.** Every other advantage exists to buy time for that one.

CHAPTER 10 — RISK REGISTER

Reviewed quarterly by the Executive. Each risk carries its owner and its live mitigation.

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
R1	**FX volatility** erodes Band A revenue in USD terms	High	High	Price locally, cost locally; USD-denominate international contracts; maintain hard-currency reserve; band multipliers reviewed, not fixed
R2	**Collection failure** — institutions that sign and do not pay	High	Medium	Term-aligned billing; direct debit and mandate where possible; automatic feature degradation before disconnection; credit assessment above a threshold
R3	**Key-person dependency** on the founder	High	Very high	Write everything down (this corpus); build a genuine executive layer in Phase I; no undocumented decisions
R4	**Over-extension** — too many sectors before depth	High	High	Volume I §2.4 depth gate; Volume VIII phase gates; sector entry requires a domain hire
R5	**Delivery quality collapse under growth**	Medium	Very high	Partner certification; templated delivery; capacity confirmed in writing before signature; hard rule: never sign what we cannot deliver
R6	**Security incident involving children's data**	Medium	Catastrophic	Volume IV Chapters 6–9; independent audit cadence; minimisation by default; breach

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
				protocol rehearsed, not merely written
R7	**Foundation model dependency** — pricing, availability, terms	Medium	High	Multi-provider routing (already in the MVP); no capability may depend on a single provider; self-hosted fallback for critical paths
R8	**Well-funded AI-native entrant** targeting the same wedge	Medium	High	Depth of record; physical estate; partner network; move faster in Phase I than a newcomer can
R9	**Political / regulatory shock** in a concentrated market	Medium	High	Geographic diversification is a risk control, not only a growth strategy — this is a core reason for the UK/US entries
R10	**Free tier costs outrun the funding capacity**	Medium	Medium	Central budget with a hard ceiling; per-tool unit-cost monitoring; degrade generosity before degrading quality
R11	**Reputational damage from an automation-driven redundancy story**	Medium	Medium	Volume I §7.1 workforce policy applied and visible; never market on headcount reduction
R12	**Hardware supply chain and import volatility**	Medium	Medium	Multi-supplier; local assembly where viable; hardware treated as an enabler, never a margin engine
R13	**Talent loss to overseas remote employers**	High	Medium	Pay competitively against remote-work benchmarks, not local ones; equity; the work itself is the

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
				retention argument
R14	**Founder ambition outrunning capital**	Medium	High	Volume VIII capital plan; phase gates that cannot be skipped by enthusiasm
R15	**AI regulation** restricting deployment in education or health	Medium	Medium	Human-in-the-loop is already architectural (Volume I P10); disclosure already policy; compliance is a small delta rather than a rebuild

Table 7 — Risk Register

Glossary

Terms are defined as this corpus uses them. Where a term also has a general industry meaning, the definition here governs internally and the cross-reference points to the chapter in which the term is established.

TERM	DEFINITION
ACV	Annual contract value. The recurring revenue a customer contributes in a year, excluding one-time implementation and build fees.
Band A / B / C	The three regional price bands defined in Volume I §6.4. All catalogue prices are quoted at Band C (list); Band A applies a 0.32× multiplier and Band B a 0.65×. The band follows the institution's operating jurisdiction, not its billing address.
CAC	Customer acquisition cost. Loaded sales and marketing cost divided by customers acquired in the period.
CAC payback	The number of months of gross profit from a customer required to recover that customer's acquisition cost.
Craft standard	The requirement in Volume VI §2.1 that creative work be indistinguishable from that of a good London or New York studio while remaining reproducible by a regional printer on the first attempt.
Credential	Any institution-issued, cryptographically signed record of an award, qualification, identity or transaction that a third party may need to verify. The subject of Volume IV, Chapter 5.
Degraded mode	The defined, designed and tested behaviour of a surface under failure — no network, slow network, provider outage. Required of every surface by Volume IV §10.2.
Ecosystem	A complete sector solution spanning all eight architectural layers, rather than a product sold into a sector. The unit of strategic expansion; see Volume I, Chapter 2.
Entrenched provision	A clause amendable only by board supermajority with published rationale and thirty days' notice. Enumerated in Volume IX §9.2.
Federation	Server-to-server interoperation across independently operated instances, allowing an institution to own its data while remaining reachable. The basis of the SpaceTalk government strategy; Volume X, Chapter 5.
Foundation tier	The permanently free tier. Not a trial and not a demo; governed by the Free Constitution in Volume I, Chapter 5.
Gate	A set of conditions that must be met before a roadmap phase may end. A phase ends when its gate is passed, not when its years elapse. Volume VIII, Chapter 2.
GRR	Gross revenue retention. Recurring revenue retained from existing customers excluding expansion; measures churn alone.
Guilloche	Fine mathematical line-work used in security printing, extremely difficult to reproduce by scan-and-print. The primary visual security element of a StromeX credential; Volume VI §6.2.
Human-in-the-loop	The requirement that a named human decides, and is recorded as deciding, wherever the stakes ladder classifies a decision as high. Volume IV §8.1.
LTV	Lifetime value. The discounted gross profit expected from a customer over the expected life of the relationship.

TERM	DEFINITION
No-fork rule	The prohibition on forking shared platform layers for a single customer without written CTO approval and a sunset date. Volume IV §3.2.
NRR	Net revenue retention. Recurring revenue from existing customers including expansion and contraction. Above 100% means the existing base grows without new customers.
Pricing Council	The standing body that owns Volume III, meets quarterly, and reviews every price against delivered margin. Volume I §8.4.
Reference Implementation	A delivered institutional deployment used as proof of method and as a permanent sales asset. Four are recorded in this edition.
Rule of 40	Revenue growth percentage plus operating margin percentage. A common composite measure of whether a software company balances growth against profitability.
Stakes ladder	The four-level classification — low, medium, high, prohibited — determining how much autonomy an AI system may exercise over a decision. Volume IV §8.1.
System of record	The authoritative store of an institution’s people, money, documents, credentials and decisions. Identified in Volume II §9 as the group’s only genuinely durable moat.
Value ledger	The running, honest account of what an institution has gained from StromeX, shown at every renewal including the periods where the numbers are unimpressive. Volume I §4.4.
Verification token	A prepaid unit purchased by an institution for verification-adjacent services carrying real marginal cost. Verification itself is always free to the verifier. Volume III §3.5.
Wave	A group of industry ecosystems opened in the same roadmap phase. Volume I §2.2.

Table 8 — Glossary of terms

References & Bibliography

Every external figure in this corpus is attributed at the point of use. This list consolidates those sources and records what each was used for. Sources were consulted in August 2026; where a source reports a market figure that moves, the figure is dated in the text.

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Internal sources

Claims in this corpus about what the group has built trace to these. Catalogue lines in Volume III are marked built, partial or specified-not-built on this basis.

StromeX MVP · apps/api, apps/web, infra

FastAPI backend with multi-provider AI routing, memory, spaced-repetition tutor and PDF export; Next.js frontend; Docker Compose infrastructure. Establishes the canonical stack in Volume IV §2.2.

Independent MVP Audit · docs/04-STROMEX-INDEPENDENT-AUDIT.md

Security, scalability, reliability and performance audit including a critical server-side request forgery vulnerability found, reproduced and fixed. Carried forward as a standing engineering rule in Volume IV §15.

Reference Implementation №1 · Sultan Hanafi Royal Schools

Four-language institutional build (English, Arabic RTL, Yorùbá, French) with approximately thirty-five page templates per locale; four verification surfaces; certificate generation with documented identifier architecture, security model and signing-key deployment; digital identity and card system; finance platform; eight role portals; personalisation centre; and approximately one hundred and twenty institutional system, governance and design documents.

Reference Implementation №2 · WorldWide English College

A seventy-three-table credential and commerce schema across fifteen migrations, covering enrolment integrity, competencies, evidence, awards, credential signing, issued documents, verifying institutions, payments, instalment plans, multi-currency routing, corporate seats and alumni chapters. The evidential basis for Volume IV §4.2.

Reference Implementation №3 · Al-Madeenah College

Bilingual static build system with offline service worker, verification surfaces, font subsetting pipeline and document generation to PDF and DOCX.

Reference Implementation №4 · Institutional portal system

Multi-role portal implementation covering student, staff, parent, applicant and administrative roles, admissions pipeline, attendance, timetable, assessment, finance and library.

Index

Generated by the build. Page references point to where each concept is established or substantively discussed; passing mentions are not indexed. Word index markers are also embedded throughout the corpus, so a live index can be built in Word if preferred.

A

B

C

E

F

G

H

N

O

P

R

S

V

Colophon

This edition is composed for A4 at 210 × 297 mm. Display matter is set in a serif book face and running text in a companion serif, with a sans for tables, captions and navigation and a monospaced face for code and architecture figures — the four typographic roles defined in Volume I, Chapter 10. The StromeX brand faces, **Archivo** and **Fraunces**, ship with this edition in `docs/bible/publication/fonts/`; the build selects them automatically wherever they are installed in the rendering environment, so the corpus can be reissued in full brand typography without editing a line of it.

The rules, tables and figures follow the design laws in Volume I, Chapter 12: typography carries the interface, space is a component, colour carries meaning, and structural devices encode something true about the content rather than decorating it. Tables use horizontal rules only; the vertical grid is carried by alignment, as it is in every well-set financial document.

This DOCX is the authoritative master. The press-quality PDF edition is generated from it and is content-identical. Both are produced from the markdown corpus of record under version control at `docs/bible/`, by the build recorded at `docs/bible/publication/`, so that the publication can be regenerated exactly whenever the corpus is amended.

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